KASTRA POS

User Guide

KASTRA Technologies

12 November 2026

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KASTRA POS — User Guide

This guide is for the people who use KASTRA POS to run a business. Owners, managers, cashiers, waiters, kitchen staff and accountants.

You do not need to understand servers, databases or code to read it. If you are installing KASTRA on a server, you want the **Admin & Installation Guide** instead.

Everything here is written as a task: *how do I take a sale*, *how do I refund someone*, *how do I close the day*. Find your task, follow the steps.

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Getting going

1. Who does what

KASTRA gives each person only what their job needs. If a screen described in this guide is missing for you, it is almost certainly your role — ask the owner.

Role	What they can do
Owner	Everything, including settings, staff and billing
Manager	Sell, manage stock, approve things, see reports, authorise voids
Cashier	Sell, look up and create customers, manage **their own** cash drawer, see **their own** sales
Waiter	Take table orders, print bills. **Cannot take payment or see reports**
Kitchen	See the kitchen screen and mark items in-progress or ready. Sees no money at all
Accountant	Reports, expenses, ledger, supplier accounts. **Cannot sell or edit stock**

Two deliberate choices worth knowing:

- A **cashier cannot browse other cashiers' takings.** The sales list shows only their own. Owners, managers and accountants see everything.
- An **accountant can see the money but cannot touch stock or staff.** Approving spending is a management act, not an accounting one.

Owners can also build **custom roles** in Settings if these six do not fit.

2. Signing in

There are two ways in, and they behave differently on purpose.

Email and password — for office work. Your session lasts **15 minutes** of inactivity before it needs refreshing. This is the secure option for anything involving money, staff or settings.

PIN — for the shop floor. Four to six digits, and the session lasts **12 hours**, so a cashier is not retyping a password all shift. Tap your name, enter your PIN. Every person needs their **own** PIN: KASTRA refuses to save a PIN that a colleague already uses, because a PIN is how it knows who rang up a sale or approved a void. If two staff already share one from before, they can still sign in by tapping their name first; a manager override will ask the owner to give each manager a different PIN.

Owners may also enable:

- **Google sign-in**
- **Two-factor (TOTP)** — an authenticator app code on top of your password. Recommended for owners, and often required
- **Fingerprint / face unlock** where the device supports it (Windows Hello must be set up on the computer: Windows Settings, Accounts, Sign-in options). On the website it only works when the app is opened through its secure `https://` address, not an IP address or plain `http://`; the installed Windows app works too. **Each place keeps its own fingerprint**: one registered on the website does not work in the desktop app, and the phone apps have their own, so register it once in every place the person will use it. An owner or manager does this under **Settings, Users**: tap the fingerprint icon beside the person, then **Register This Device**, and the person touches the sensor. The button is available on the Pro and Enterprise plans, and to every business during its trial. To sign in, pick your name on the **Staff PIN** screen and tap **Use Fingerprint / Face ID**. If it is cancelled, times out or has nothing registered on that device, the screen now says so in words; use your PIN meanwhile. (The macOS and Linux desktop apps do not support it yet.)

  "No sales found" when you know there are sales? Your session quietly expired. Sign in again. If it keeps happening on a shared shop-floor device, ask the owner to switch that device to PIN login.

3. Your first sale in 60 seconds

1. Open **POS**.
2. Type the first few letters of the item, or scan its barcode.
3. Click the item. It lands in the cart on the right.
4. Click **Charge** (or press **F1** for a straight cash sale).
5. Pick how the customer is paying.
6. Enter what they handed over. KASTRA shows the change.
7. **Complete**. The receipt prints or sends.

That is the whole loop. Everything below is detail on top of it.

Selling

4. The POS screen

Three areas:

- **Left / centre — the item grid.** Your products, grouped by category. Tap to add.
- **Top — the search bar.** Typing here searches names, SKUs and barcodes.
- **Right — the cart.** Lines, quantities, discounts, the running total, and the **Charge** button.

Keyboard shortcuts (they work when you are not typing in a box):

Key	Does
`/`	Jump to search
`F1`	Charge as cash
`F5`	Hold the current sale
`F6`	Recall a held sale

The screen adapts to your business type. A restaurant asks which table first; a fuel station asks which pump; a supermarket runs a denser, scan-heavy layout. Same cart underneath.

5. Adding items to the cart

Search — type any part of the name, the SKU, or the barcode.

Scan — use a USB/Bluetooth scanner, or the camera. A scanner just types into the search box, so it works anywhere the box is focused.

Quick price entry — type `3x500` and press Enter to add **three of the item that costs KES 500**. `3x500` and `3*500` work too. This is built for market stalls and kiosks where staff know goods by price rather than name. Note it matches on **price, not quantity of shillings** — if two items both cost 500, it takes the first.

Weighed goods — scan the label a weighing scale prints (a GS1 barcode). KASTRA reads the weight, subtracts the **tare** (the container's own weight, set per item), and prices the net. A toast confirms: *"Scanned: Beef — Net: 1.240 kg (tare: 0.010 kg deducted)"*.

Price levels — retail and wholesale. Switch the level on the cart before charging and every line reprices.

Overriding a price — allowed if your role permits it, and it is recorded against your name.

Two things may interrupt you, by design:

- **Age gate** — for age-restricted goods, KASTRA asks you to confirm the customer's age before the line is added.
- **Expiry warning** — if stock about to be sold is expired or close to it, KASTRA stops and shows you which batch. See section 16.

6. Taking payment

Click **Charge**. The payment window offers:

Method	Notes
Cash	Type what the customer handed over; change is calculated
M-Pesa — STK Push	Sends the prompt to the customer's phone. They enter their PIN
M-Pesa — QR Code	Shows a QR on screen for the customer to scan
M-Pesa — Paybill / Till	For manual paybill payments; enter the reference
Card — Paystack	Card payment through Paystack
Card — Terminal	A connected card terminal (Ingenico, PAX, Verifone)
NFC	Tap-to-pay where supported
Bank Transfer	Records bank, account name, branch and reference
Credit Sale	Puts it on the customer's account. Needs a customer, and respects their credit limit
Gift Card	Scan or type the card code; shows the remaining balance
Room Charge	Hotel mode — type the room number; the sale is added to the folio of the guest checked in to that room and paid at check-out. A room with no checked-in guest is refused
Split Pay	Any combination of the above

Split payments are the common real-world case: KES 1,000 in cash and the rest on M-Pesa. Choose **Split Pay**, add each part, and KASTRA tracks *Remaining to pay* until it reaches zero.

On credit sales, if the amount would push the customer past their limit, KASTRA blocks it and says *"Credit limit exceeded"*. A manager can raise the limit on the customer's record.

On M-Pesa STK, the screen shows *"Waiting for payment"* while the customer approves on their phone. Do not hand over goods until it confirms. If they never respond it times out and you can retry or switch method.

7. Receipts

After a sale you can:

- **Print** to a thermal receipt printer. Choose the printer once in **Settings, Printers, Receipt printing (this device)** and every sale prints to it without asking. See *Setting up your receipt printer* below

- **Send by SMS or WhatsApp** — automatic when the sale has a customer with a phone number
- **Email** it
- Show a **digital receipt** on screen for the customer to photograph
- Print an **A4 invoice** instead of a receipt, for business customers

Setting up your receipt printer

Each till or phone keeps its own printer choice. New devices start on **System printer**, which works the way printing works in any other program: the print window lists every printer installed on that computer, including thermal printers, and you pick one. Nothing has to be paired.

1. Install the thermal printer on the computer as usual (its driver and a test page).
2. Open **Settings, Printers**. Under **Receipt printing (this device)** keep **System printer**.
3. Choose the **Paper size**: 58 mm for small rolls, 80 mm for standard thermal printers.
4. Press **Print test receipt**, pick your thermal printer in the print window, and check the slip.

In the **KASTRA POS desktop app** the first choice is **Installed printer, no print window**. Pick your thermal printer from the list of printers installed on the computer, press **Print test receipt**, and every sale then prints straight to it with no window. It needs a thermal receipt printer (it sends receipt commands, so a laser or inkjet printer would print them as text).

In the browser, after a sale press **Print** and choose the printer in the window; the browser remembers your last choice. To skip the window, make the thermal printer the computer's default printer, start Chrome or Edge with the `--kiosk-printing` option, and switch on **Print automatically after each sale**.

Advanced: direct thermal printing

Under **Advanced** you can choose USB thermal, Bluetooth thermal, LAN thermal (through the server), Star or Epson. These send the receipt straight to one device instead of using the installed-printer list, so they ignore the computer's drivers. Use them for phones, or for printers with no driver.

- For USB or Bluetooth press **Pair** and pick the printer. On Windows a printer that already has its driver installed is usually not available for USB pairing; use the system printer instead.
- For a Star or Epson printer type its address and press **Save**.
- For a LAN printer, first add it below with connection type NETWORK and an address such as `192.168.1.50:9100`.
- Once a direct printer is chosen, **Print automatically after each sale** is switched on, and the Print and Reprint buttons go straight to it. Turn the switch off to print only on request.
- Choose **Ask each time** to see the picker every time.

USB and Bluetooth printing needs Chrome or Edge (on a computer or an Android phone); it does not work in Safari on iPhone or iPad. In those browsers use the system printer, or a LAN, Star or Epson printer.

You can customise the header, footer, logo and wording in **Settings -> Receipt**.

8. Holding and recalling a sale

A customer forgot their wallet and is going to the car. Do not cancel the sale.

- **F5** or **Hold** parks the cart under a name or number.
- **F6** or **Recall** brings it back.

The till is free for the next customer in between. Held sales are not sales yet — nothing has been recorded and no stock has moved.

9. Fixing mistakes: cart edit, void, refund

This is the section worth reading twice, because the three are genuinely different and KASTRA treats them differently on purpose.

Before payment — just edit the cart

Remove the line, change the quantity, start over. Nothing has happened yet: no receipt, no stock movement, no record. **No manager, no reason, no audit trail.**

After payment — void

The receipt exists, so undoing it is a formal act.

- Requires a **manager PIN** and a **written reason**
- Either **the whole sale** or **specific lines**
- Writes a permanent entry to the audit log that nobody can edit or delete
- **Puts the stock back**
- Sends a **void or amendment to KRA** through eTIMS

Use a void when the sale should never have happened — wrong item rung up, duplicate charge, customer changed their mind at the counter.

- The **books are corrected too**: the sale's revenue, tax and payment are taken back
- A **credit sale** can be voided (what the customer owed is cancelled), unless part of it has been paid
- A **prescription** that was dispensed is returned by voiding its sale: stock comes back, the prescription is waiting again (or goes back to its previous fill), the insurer's claim is cancelled and the controlled-drug register gets a return line. To take back only some of the medicines, void just those lines (or part of a quantity): the patient keeps the rest and the insurer's claim comes down by its share. You can do this once per fill. Not possible once the insurer has paid that claim
- A **pump sale** is voided from the fuel screen's **Sales** list (managers): the litres go back into the tank and a fleet account is credited

Later — refund / return

The customer comes back tomorrow with the goods. Use **Return** from the sale in the sales list. Stock comes back in, the money goes out, and the return is linked to the original sale.

> **Rule of thumb:** cart edit = nothing happened. Void = it happened and we are cancelling it. Return = it happened, it stood, and now goods are coming back.

10. Customers, credit and loyalty

Add a customer from the POS or from **Customers**. Useful fields: phone (drives SMS and WhatsApp receipts), KRA PIN (needed on B2B invoices), and **credit limit**.

Credit / account sales — sell now, collect later. The customer's outstanding balance shows on their record and in the **Credit Book** report. Record payments against the account as they come in.

Loyalty — customers earn points on qualifying sales and redeem them as payment. Set the earn and redeem rates in Settings.

Gift cards — sell them, check balances, redeem them at the till.

Your kind of business

KASTRA runs one till that changes shape depending on your business type. Set it in **Settings -> Business type**.

11. Restaurant, café and bar

Tables. The floor plan shows your tables grouped by area. Tap a table to start or continue its order. Tables can be **merged**, **transferred** to another table, and **split** for separate bills.

The order is not a sale. Food goes to the kitchen long before anyone pays. KASTRA keeps *orders* (what the kitchen is making) separate from *sales* (money that changed hands). The order becomes a sale when the bill is settled.

Taking payment on a phone. On the table's order screen, tap **Bill** when the guest asks for it, then **Take payment** (it appears once the bill is requested, and you can also choose it straight from the "Bill requested" message). The checkout shows exactly what is on the table, with no cart involved, and the table is freed when payment goes through. If someone adds or voids a line on another screen while you are at the checkout, the payment is refused with a message and you reopen the order to see the new total, so nobody is charged an amount they were not shown. A table cannot be paid while offline, because the order has to be closed on the server; the phone tells you the table is still open instead of queuing the payment. As on the web till, no service charge is added to a table bill, because dine-in prices already include it.

The bill is the order. When you take payment for a table, the sale is built from what is on the order, at the prices it was taken at, with any priced extras included. It does not depend on what the till screen sends. The payments must cover the total, and the order is closed in the same step, so two tills cannot both take payment for one table. A sale on a normal (paid-up) sale needs payments that cover the total; credit and layaway sales are the exceptions.

Selling out of stock. An item marked sold out can still be ordered and sold, so a forgotten stock receipt never stops service. Stock simply goes negative (sell 5 with none in hand and it shows -5), and when you later receive stock it is added on top, so the 5 you already sold come off automatically. To make an item *refuse* to sell at zero, set its stock policy to Block.

Kitchen tickets (KOT). When you send an order, it is split into one ticket per station — **Kitchen**, **Bar** or **Dessert** — so the bartender sees only the drinks and the cook only the food. Each ticket has a number that restarts at #1 every day. Set where an item is made on the item itself (**Inventory, Edit item, Made at**). Leave it on *Automatic* and KASTRA guesses from the name and category, with the kitchen as the fallback. Each station's tickets print on the printer set up for it in Settings, Printers.

Send an order twice by mistake and nothing is cooked twice: lines already sent are refused, and the waiter's screen says so.

No kitchen screen? A kitchen display needs a second screen or computer, and many restaurants and hotels do not have one. Go to **Settings, General, "How does your kitchen receive orders?"** and choose **Printed tickets only**. The Kitchen Display menu and KDS button disappear. When the waiter sends an order, a ticket prints for the kitchen (food to the kitchen printer, drinks to the bar printer) and the order is recorded as handed over straight away, so nothing waits on a screen and the table never shows a "waiting" or "ready" badge. If something is voided after it was sent, a second slip prints saying **CANCEL - DO NOT MAKE**, so the kitchen hears about it without a screen. Switch back to **Kitchen display** at any time.

Voiding on a table. Open the table and tap **Void** beside a line to take back all or only some of it: for example, if 10 ugali were sent and the guest wants one fewer, enter 1 and the order keeps 9 (the total and the kitchen ticket follow). **Void order** takes back the whole order. Every void needs a **reason** from a short list (entered by mistake, customer changed their mind, wrong item, out of stock, waited too long, kitchen error, complaint, guests left, or "Other" with a few words). Removing something the kitchen has not received needs nothing more. Once the kitchen has it, a **manager must approve**: a manager signed in approves their own; anyone else asks a manager to type their PIN. Managers and owners review every void under **Tables, Voids** (who, what, how much, why, and who approved), and see food that was made and then voided as wastage. An order that has already been **paid** is voided from its receipt in Sales (see section 9).

Kitchen display (KDS). Instead of paper, the kitchen can run a screen showing live tickets, on a wall screen, a tablet or a phone. Tickets arrive the moment they are sent (with an optional chime), and turn amber then red as they wait. Pick **Kitchen**, **Bar** or **Dessert** along the top to dedicate a screen to one station; the choice is remembered on that device. Each ticket shows the table or room, the waiter, modifiers, special instructions in a highlighted box, allergens, and a **+ Add-on** tag when it adds to an order already being made. Kitchen staff tap **Start**, then **Ready**; a drink goes straight to **Ready**. A ticket marked ready by mistake can be **recalled**. Waiters (and managers) mark it **Served** from the order panel or the display.

On a shared kitchen screen, switch on **Shared**. To start a ticket the cook taps **their name**, then types their PIN. The ticket is then recorded against that cook, not the screen's login.

Voids and cancellations reach the kitchen. Cancelling an order cancels its open tickets. Removing a line the kitchen already has needs a **manager** and a reason; the line comes off its ticket and every kitchen screen shows a red warning ("Stop making it") with a chime, instead of the cooks finding out when the guest asks.

Kitchen on a phone. The mobile app has the same kitchen screen: the same live tickets, station tabs, and Start / Ready / Recall buttons. A kitchen account opens straight onto it and signs out from its header. Waiters mark tickets served from the table's order screen.

A restaurant or hotel inside another business. Your POS mode is your main till. A fuel station, shop or supermarket that also runs a kitchen can switch on **Restaurant & kitchen** under Settings, *Also run*, which adds Tables, bar tabs, happy hours, the waitlist and the Kitchen Display without changing the main till. **Hotel & rooms** does the same for rooms, bookings, guest folios and housekeeping. Both are off by default, and these features are refused by the server (not just hidden) for a business that has not enabled them. A Hospitality till already includes both; Fast Food and Bar include the restaurant.

What the menu shows for your kind of business. The menu only lists what your kind of business uses, so a salon is not offered Field Orders or Delivery Routes and a table-service restaurant is not offered Delivery. Three more features can be switched on the same way (Settings, *Also run*): **Delivery & online orders** (Delivery, Online Orders, Delivery Dispatch), **Field sales** (Agent Dashboard, Field Orders, Delivery Routes), **Quotes (proforma invoices)** and **Goods trading tools** (Bundles / Kits, RFQ, AI Forecasting). They are on by default for the

main tills that use them:

Main till	Delivery & online orders	Field sales	Quotes	Goods trading tools
Retail, Supermarket	on	on	on	on
Fast Food	on	off	off	on
Hospitality, Bar, Clinic	off	off	off	on
Salon, Fuel, Cybercafe	off	off	off	off

Stock, suppliers, stocktake, finance, staff and payroll are never hidden, whatever your main till.

The till entry is named for your business. The first entry under Sales opens your main till, and it is labelled for it: *Supermarket POS*, *Restaurant POS*, *Counter POS*, *Bar POS*, *Fuel Forecourt*, *Cybercafe POS*, *Clinic POS* or *Salon POS* (*Point of Sale* for a shop). A fuel station and a cybercafe no longer list their till twice.

A feature that is off **turns itself on the first time you really use it**: an online order placed on your store, a delivery you create, a field order or route, or a proforma you write. Its menu entry then appears, so an order or a quote can never arrive somewhere you cannot see it. Businesses that already had delivery, field sales or quotes data were switched on for them when this was introduced.

Modifiers. "No onions", "extra shot", "well done" — and they can carry a price.

Bar tabs. Open a tab against a customer or a name, keep adding to it, settle at the end of the night.

Service charge. Applied automatically at your configured rate.

Reservations and the waitlist. Take bookings ahead of time, and manage walk-ins waiting for a table.

12. Hotel

- **Rooms** — availability, rates, status
- **Bookings** — check guests in and out
- **Deposits** — take a deposit when booking, or later with **Take a Deposit**, in cash, M-Pesa, card or bank. It is used against the bill at check-out; if it is more than the bill, the rest is paid back the way it came in. Cancel a reservation and the deposit is paid back, or a manager can keep it
- **Guest folio** — everything the guest charges during their stay, on one bill
- **Check-out invoice** — when your business records hotel takings as sales (ask the owner to check), check-out produces a proper tax invoice with a receipt number and goes to KRA. For a company guest, enter their KRA PIN when booking so it prints on the invoice
- **Hotel levies** — if your hotel charges a tourism or catering levy, the owner or manager adds it once in **Settings > Hotel levies** and it is added to every guest bill. Leave it empty if you charge none
- **Room charge** — the restaurant and bar can bill straight to a room. The sale appears on the guest's folio as a "charged sale" and is paid at check-out with the rest of the bill; it is

not billed a second time on the stay's invoice. If it was a mistake, void the sale while the guest is still in the room
- **Housekeeping** — a live queue of rooms needing service
- **Channel manager** — keeps availability in step with booking sites

13. Pharmacy

- **Visits: the clinic's day** — **Visits** in the menu is the queue. Press **New visit**, choose the patient (or register them), say what they came for and mark it **Urgent** if it is: urgent patients are seen first, then the longest wait. A patient cannot be queued twice while a visit is open. Each visit moves left to right:
  1. **Waiting**, then **Triage**: the nurse or front desk takes **vitals** (temperature, pulse, breathing, oxygen, blood pressure, weight, height, blood sugar, pain). Readings outside the usual adult range are flagged as you type (a prompt, not a diagnosis; nothing is flagged for a child under 12). A slipped decimal, such as a temperature of 370, is refused.
  2. **With the doctor**: only a doctor (or a manager) takes the patient in, and the patient is then that doctor's: another doctor cannot change the notes. The doctor writes the history, examination, assessment and plan, picks **diagnoses** (search by name or ICD-10 code, or type your own), and can add **sick leave days**, a **referral** and a **follow-up date**. **Sick note** and **Referral letter** print for the patient to carry. Prescriptions are written from the visit (**Write a prescription for this visit**), under the doctor's own name; the patient's allergies show on every tab.
  3. **To bill**: finishing the consultation needs at least one diagnosis. The front desk adds the services done (consultation, lab tests, procedures: **services** from Items & Stock, at their listed price) and presses **Take payment and complete**. With real sales switched on (Settings) the charges become one invoice with a KRA receipt (optionally with the buyer's KRA PIN); otherwise the visit just closes. Medicines are not on the visit bill: they are paid for when the pharmacy dispenses them. A visit can be **cancelled** with a reason (the patient left) until it is completed, and sent **back to the doctor** before it is billed. Each patient's page lists their earlier visits.
- **Follow-ups** — when a doctor sets a follow-up date, the patient appears on the **Follow-ups** tab of **Visits** (overdue, due today, coming up in the next 14 days) until they have been reached or have already come back for another visit. **Send SMS** texts a short reminder that names the clinic and the date and nothing about the illness (it needs SMS set up for the business); **Mark reached** is for a phone call. A patient with no phone number cannot be texted. A nurse sees the list but the front desk and managers do the reaching.
- **Critical lab results** — a critical value tells the clinicians at once (a notification) and shows a red warning on the visit's **Lab** tab until a doctor presses **Critical: I have seen this**; who and when are kept. A corrected value must be acknowledged again. Reference ranges can have a separate range for **children under 12** (the common tests carry one for haemoglobin), and the range used is printed with each result. **Imaging** (chest X-ray and ultrasound are in the common tests) takes no specimen: press *Patient attended*, then type the **Findings** and **Impression**. The images themselves are not stored in KASTRA. **Print label** on a collected order prints a small specimen label.
- **Sending a rejected claim again** — in **Insurance Claims**, open a rejected claim and press **Correct and send again**: fix the member number, pre-authorisation number or the ICD-11 codes. A new claim is made, the old one stays as the record and points to it, and each rejected claim can be sent again once. The rejection already wrote the amount off the books, so if the insurer pays the new claim it is booked as recovered income, not a second receivable.

- **Credit notes from supplier returns** — marking a return **Credited** asks for the supplier's credit note number (blank is numbered for you) and the amount actually credited, and records a credit note against the supplier, linked to the return. A number already on record is refused and the return stays open.
- **Resubmitting a rejected claim** — open the rejected claim under **Insurance Claims** and press **Correct and send again**. Fix the member number, add a pre-authorisation number or the ICD-11 codes the insurer asked for, and a new claim is raised as *billed*; the old one stays as the record and points to it. Because the rejection already wrote the amount off the books, a payment on the new claim is recovered income, not a second receivable. Each rejected claim can be sent again once; if the new one is rejected too, correct and send that one.
- **Supplier credit** — when you mark a supplier return **Credited**, KASTRA asks for the supplier's credit note number (blank means it numbers one for you) and the amount actually credited, and records a credit note against the supplier that can be set against a later order.
- **Laboratory extras** — **Children** under 12 can have their own normal range on a test (set it in the test list; the starter haemoglobin has one) and are judged against it. A **critical result** is announced to the clinicians in their notifications the moment it is entered, and the doctor presses **Critical: I have seen this**: who and when are kept, and a corrected value must be acknowledged again. **Print label** makes a small specimen label. **Imaging** (X-ray and ultrasound are in the starter list) works like any test with a typed *Findings* and *Impression*, no specimen is taken (the button says *Patient attended*), and a second person still releases it. The images themselves are not stored in KASTRA.
- **Compliance records** — **Compliance Records** in the menu (owner, manager and pharmacist), for an inspection or a patient's request. Choose a period (today, 7 days, 30 days, this month, or dates) and each register can be **downloaded as CSV** or **printed** with a line for the pharmacist in charge to sign. They are exports of the records KASTRA holds, laid out for filing: they are not the official forms, so check what your regulator asks for.
  - **Controlled drugs**: every entry (medicine, schedule, quantity, patient and ID, prescriber and licence, prescription number, who dispensed it) with, for each controlled medicine, what was dispensed in the period next to the stock held now. Medicines are matched by name.
  - **Dispensing**: every prescription whose latest fill fell in the period, with its medicines and who dispensed it.
  - **Disposals**: expired, damaged and recalled stock written off in Batch & Expiry, with the lot, cost and who authorised it.
  - **Patient data request**: when a patient asks what is held about them, choose the patient and **download all data** (a file with the record, visits and notes, prescriptions, lab results, cover checks and claims) or **print a readable copy**. Check who is asking first: this is health information. Each export is recorded on the audit log with your name and the time. KASTRA does not delete or anonymise patient records: how long health records must be kept and when they may be erased is for you to settle with your adviser, so ask us before relying on any deletion.
- **Appointments to visits** — in a clinic, **Appointments** has a **Check in as visit** button on booked and confirmed appointments. It finds the patient (starting from the phone and name on the booking, or registers them), puts them in the **Visits** queue with the booked services already on the bill, and moves the appointment to *In progress*. Finishing the visit completes the appointment (it is not invoiced a second time); cancelling the visit cancels it, so it does not keep holding the slot. An appointment that holds a deposit cannot be checked in this way: complete it from Appointments so the deposit is applied. A nurse

cannot check patients in from appointments.

- **Clinic reports** — **Clinic Reports** in the menu (owner and manager) shows, for today, 7 days, 30 days, this month or dates you choose: visits per day, how long patients waited to be triaged and to see the doctor, how long consultations took, the **diagnoses** seen most often (split into children under 5 and everyone else, with a **Download CSV**), what each **doctor** did, who came (women and men, by age band), what the clinic charged for services on completed visits, and the lab's ordered, released, critical and average time for each test. Figures count a diagnosis once per visit and only for visits whose consultation was finished. Days are Nairobi days.
- **Insurer prices** — an insurer may pay a different price from your list price for some services or medicines. Under **Pharmacy Mgmt, Insurance Providers**, press **Prices** beside the insurer (owner and manager), pick an item and enter what that insurer pays. From then on, a visit or a dispensed prescription billed to that insurer is priced at that figure for those items and at your list price for everything else; the billing window shows the total before you confirm, and the claim is raised on the insurer's prices. Items with no price set for the insurer are unaffected, and removing a price puts the item back on your list price. Sales already made keep the price they were made at.
- **Nurse accounts** — add them under Settings (Staff) with the role **Nurse**. A nurse registers patients, queues them, takes **vitals** and takes lab specimens, and can read the record and prescriptions. A nurse cannot take a patient in to the doctor, write a prescription, add charges, bill, cancel a visit, order tests or enter results, and sees no till, money or reports.
- **The laboratory** — **Laboratory** in the menu. A manager opens **Test list** and presses **Load common tests** (about 20: malaria, full blood count, blood sugar, HIV, urinalysis, kidney and liver tests and more), then reviews the normal ranges: they are general adult ranges, so your lab lead should check them against your own methods. Each test says what it measures and its normal range (with a separate range for women where that applies, and *critical* limits), and can be **charged as** a service from Items & Stock so it lands on the visit's bill.
    1. **Order.** The doctor (or a manager) opens the visit's **Lab** tab and presses **Order tests**, picks the tests, adds a note for the lab and marks them **Urgent** if needed. Tests are always ordered inside an open visit, so they are billed with it (for a walk-in who only needs a test, open a visit for them first). The same test is not ordered twice while the first is unfinished.
    2. **Collect.** Whoever takes the specimen opens the order on the **Laboratory** worklist and presses **Specimen collected**. Until then nothing can be entered. An order can be cancelled (with a reason, and its charge comes off the visit) only before the specimen is taken.
    3. **Results.** The lab technician (or a manager) types each value. KASTRA judges it against the patient's own range, so the same haemoglobin can be normal for a man and low for a woman, and marks it *low*, *high*, *abnormal* or *critical*. A critical value shows a red warning to the lab and to the doctor.
    4. **Release.** A **second person** checks and releases the result (a manager can release their own, for a one-person lab). The doctor sees results as *waiting to be checked* until then and cannot rely on them. A released result cannot be edited: only a manager can **send it back for correction**, with a reason that is kept. Released results can be **printed** as a lab report, and the patient's earlier results stay on record. A test can be given a **turnaround time in hours** (in the test list). An order not released within that time shows an **overdue** badge on the worklist and moves to the top, so late results are not forgotten. Create the lab technician under **Settings, Staff** with the role **Lab technician**: they sign in to the lab and see nothing else.
- **Connecting to SHA** — each business connects with its **own** SHA credentials: nothing

is shared between businesses. SHA gives a facility a **client id**, a **client secret** and a **Facility Registry code** when it is onboarded. An owner or manager opens **Insurance Claims, SHA connection, Set up**, enters them and the service address, saves, and presses **Test connection**. The secret is stored encrypted and is never shown again (leave it blank when editing to keep it). The address starts as DHA's published **test** address; use the live address SHA gives you for real patients. Only addresses on SHA's or DHA's own domains are accepted. **Switched on** can be unticked to pause checks without deleting the credentials, and **Remove** deletes them. Then, in **Check cover** (on a patient, or in the billing window) for an insurer set up as SHA, **Ask SHA now** sends the identifier (National ID, ClientRegistry ID, Alien ID, Refugee ID, Mandate Number, birth certificate or notification) and records the answer as a cover check made by SHA. *Active* is recorded as eligible, *inactive* (or a person SHA has no record of, or one recorded as deceased) as not eligible, and an answer KASTRA cannot read as clearly active or inactive is recorded as *could not check* with what SHA said: it is never taken as eligible, so billing stays blocked until a person decides. If SHA is down or refuses the credentials nothing is recorded and the screen says why; recording by hand always remains. **What is not built:** sending claims to SHA. Claims still go in through SHA's own portal or your certified HMIS, because SHA's claim submission needs the patient's consent step and a format we have not been given and cannot test. The connection was written from DHA's published description and tested against a stand-in, not against SHA itself: if SHA's real answers differ, **Test connection** and the *could not check* note will show it, and the advanced paths and request format can be changed without a new version.

- **Insurance cover and claims** — set up each insurer once under **Pharmacy Mgmt, Insurance Providers** (there is a one-press button for **Social Health Authority (SHA)**). *Confirm cover before billing this insurer* is on by default, and SHA needs it.
  1. **Check cover.** Look the member up with the insurer (their portal, the card, a phone call), then press **Check cover** on the patient's page, or **Record cover check** when billing. Choose *Eligible*, *Not eligible* or *Could not check* (their system was down), and add the insurer's reference if they gave one. The result is kept with your name and the time. A patient with no insurer on file gets the one that was found eligible, so the next visit starts filled in. KASTRA does not yet ask the insurer's system for you: you type what they told you.
  2. **Bill the insurer.** When completing a visit, tick *An insurer pays part of this bill*, choose the insurer, enter the member number and the percentage the **patient** pays (0 when the insurer pays everything). For an insurer that needs a check, the button stays off until cover has been confirmed *for this visit*; a member found *Not eligible* cannot be billed to the insurer (bill the patient, or correct the member number and check again). The patient pays their share, the insurer's share becomes a **claim**, and on real sales the invoice shows it as owed by the insurer.
  3. **ICD-11 for SHA.** SHA's published guidance asks for ICD-11 diagnosis codes. Beside each diagnosis the doctor can enter its **ICD-11 code** (for example 1F40). The claim is flagged until every diagnosis has one.
  4. **Follow the claims. Insurance Claims** in the menu (owner, manager and accountant) shows what each insurer owes by age (0-30, 31-60, 61-90, over 90 days) and, for every claim, what is still holding it back: no member number, cover not confirmed, no diagnosis, no ICD-11 code. Open a claim to see the patient, diagnoses and services, **print** it for the insurer's portal or form, set the insurer's **claim number** and any **pre-authorisation** number, then mark **Insurer approved**, **Payment received** (enter what actually arrived) or **Insurer rejected** with the reason. A shortfall or a rejection is written off in the books.
- **Patients** — every person you treat has one record (**Patients** in the menu): name, phone,

ID number, date of birth, weight, **allergies**, conditions, whether pregnant or breastfeeding, next of kin and insurer. Register someone once; when you type a name, phone or ID the screen warns if they may already be registered. An ID number can belong to only one patient. Earlier prescriptions written with just a name can be added to the right record from the patient's page (manager)

- **One drug list** — **Pharmacy Mgmt > Drug List** is the single list of the drugs you handle: generic and brand name, strength, form, category, controlled schedule, default instructions, the **maximum a day** for an adult and **cautions** (such as pregnancy). It used to be two lists (catalogue and formulary); anything in the old catalogue was copied across. **Load starter list** adds about thirty common drugs with their usual daily limits and cautions, and common drug interactions, so the safety check works from day one. It only adds what is missing and never changes what you already have, so it is safe to press again. It is general information: have your pharmacist review it and set controlled schedules to match your licence
- **Pharmacist and the stock side** — a pharmacist can see the suppliers and purchase orders, **receive goods against an order** (entering the lot number and expiry date, which creates the lot), look at stock by lot and the expiry dashboard, and **return stock to a supplier** from a lot. A pharmacist cannot create purchase orders, recall or write off a lot, or see supplier invoices and payments: those stay with the owner and manager.
- **Pharmacist and Doctor accounts** — add them under Settings (Staff). A **pharmacist** works the till and the dispensing counter like a cashier, keeps the drug list and the controlled-drug register, and can set a safety warning aside or approve a sale without a prescription with their own login (or by entering their PIN on a cashier's screen). A **doctor** signs in to the patient list, writes prescriptions (the prescriber is their own name) and reads patient records and the drug list; a doctor cannot dispense, sell, or see money, reports or staff
- **Prescriptions** are written against a patient record. Each medicine keeps its dose, how often and for how many days, and the prescription prints them. While it is being written the **safety check** shows problems before it is saved
- **Safety check** — before anything is dispensed the system checks the patient's allergies (a medicine or its whole family, so a penicillin allergy stops amoxicillin), medicines that interact with each other or with what the patient is already taking from another prescription in the last month, the same medicine written twice, a daily dose above the usual maximum (set in the **Formulary**), and pregnancy. A **Stop** cannot be passed except by a manager, with a reason: their PIN is entered on the screen and the name, reason and what was set aside are kept on record. Other findings are shown for the pharmacist to judge. The check only knows what has been entered: keep the patient's allergies, the interaction list and the formulary up to date
- **Medicine details** — on each item (Items & Stock, for a clinic) enter the generic name, strength, form and drug class, choose a **controlled schedule** (II to V) if it is controlled, and tick **Needs a prescription** if it is sold on prescription only. The safety check and the controlled-drug register run on these, so a medicine without them is not checked
- **Selling without a prescription** — a medicine marked *Needs a prescription*, or any controlled drug, is refused on the ordinary till. A manager can approve the sale with a reason (a controlled drug also needs the buyer's name); it is recorded and a controlled drug goes on the register. This cannot be done offline. The same rule applies when a **quotation** is converted to a sale (the manager's approval window appears on the Proformas screen), and on the phone till (the approval window appears there too, and a sale made offline is refused when it reaches the server). It also covers invoices for hotel rooms, cyber, fuel and appointments, tabs and **online orders**: those cannot carry such a medicine at all, and the public online menu does not list them. Dispense it from Prescriptions instead

- **Dispensing and payment** — when your business records pharmacy takings as sales (ask the owner to check), pressing **Dispense** (or **Process Refill**) shows the price of the medicines, takes the patient's payment and prints a receipt that goes to KRA. Every medicine on the prescription must be linked to a catalogue item with a price, otherwise the screen names the one to fix. Set each medicine's tax class in the catalogue (many are exempt) so the receipt shows the right VAT
- **Insurance** — tick *Insurance covers part of this*, choose the insurer, enter the member number and the percentage the patient pays. The patient pays only their share; the rest is recorded as a claim to that insurer. When the insurer pays, open **Claims**, mark it **Approved** then **Paid** and enter the amount received: any shortfall is written off and the books are updated
- **Batch and expiry tracking** enforced — see section 16
- Controlled items flagged and recorded

14. Fuel station, cyber café and other trades

- **Fuel station** — see Running a fuel station below. The shop, lubricants and LPG are sold on **Shop & Lubricants** in the menu; the **Point of Sale** entry is the forecourt.
- **Cyber café** — start and stop timed sessions per station, bill the time. Stations are counter-managed on the web app. When your business records cyber takings as sales (ask the owner to check), ending a session gives a proper receipt that goes to KRA, with the time (or package), printing and other services on separate lines. **Credit is only for registered customers**: pick the customer when you end the session. For a company customer enter their KRA PIN. To undo an ended session, void its sale from the sales list
- **Salon / clinic** — an appointment diary with bookings against staff. Choose the **service** when booking so it is priced. When your business records these takings as sales (ask the owner to check): a **deposit** is recorded as money taken (say how it was paid; **Deposit** adds more); **Complete** takes the payment (the deposit is used first, anything left over is paid back) and gives a receipt that goes to KRA; **Cancel** or **No-Show** pays the deposit back, or a manager can keep it. Only a manager can change a service's price. To undo a completed appointment, void its sale from the sales list

  Salon: stylists, visits and clients. Open **Team** (managers) to switch on the people who take appointments and set their weekly working hours; a booking outside someone's hours, or on top of another of their appointments, is refused. Give a service a **length in minutes** in Items & Stock and booking fills in the price and works out when the visit ends. One visit can have several services in a row, each with its own stylist (for example a cut and then a colour). **By stylist** shows the day as a board, one column per stylist. At **Complete** you can add retail products (they come off stock) and record a **tip**. The tip is kept apart from the tax invoice, so the receipt total stays exact, and is booked as money owed to staff. Each stylist earns commission on the lines that name them, not the cashier; on the till, pick **Served by** on a service line. Pick the client when booking to see their past visits, no-shows and **notes** (allergies, colour formula, preferences). Completing only creates a receipt when the owner has switched on real sales for this kind of business (Settings); otherwise it just marks the visit done, and the screen says so.
- **Supermarket** — a denser, faster scan-first layout built for queues

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Stock and suppliers

Running a fuel station

The fuel screen has tabs. Attendants see **Forecourt**, **Shift**, **Tanks**, **Prices** and **Sales**; managers also see **Wet stock**, **Fleet accounts**, **Reports** and **Setup**.

Set up once (manager). Under **Prices**, add each grade you sell with today's pump price. Under **Tanks**, add each underground tank, then **Measure** it once to set how much fuel it holds. Under **Setup**, add each pump and its **nozzles**. Every nozzle sells one grade, draws from one tank and has its own meter, so a pump that sells petrol and diesel gets two nozzles.

Every day: the shift. Fuel can only be sold inside a shift, so every litre has someone answering for it. 1. **Shift, Open a shift.** Add the attendants on duty, give each nozzle to one attendant and enter what each pump meter reads. If a meter does not read what it closed at last time, you must say why (a replaced meter, for example); the difference is kept. 2. **Forecourt.** Tap the nozzle the customer used, enter the litres from the pump display, choose how they paid and record the sale. Payment can be cash, M-Pesa, card, a **fleet account**, or **customer credit** (registered customers only). 3. **Shift, Close shift.** Enter each nozzle's closing meter and the cash each attendant hands in. The system compares what each meter says with what was rung up (and with any pump tests), and each attendant's cash with their cash sales. Fuel through a meter that nobody rang up, and cash that is short, are shown in red and kept with the shift. Sales in a closed shift cannot be added to it.

A **voided** sale (manager, from **Sales**) puts the litres back into the tank. The fuel still went through the meter, so it still shows as unrecorded at the shift close: that is intended, because a drive-off is a loss.

Pump tests. Fuel drawn to test a pump and poured back moves the meter but is not a sale. A manager records it from the live shift (**Record test**), so the meter check does not count it as missing.

Tanks and wet stock. - **Measure** a tank every day from the dip stick or gauge. The system keeps what it found against what the books said it should hold; the difference is fuel lost or gained. The first measurement of a new tank sets its opening level and is not counted as a gain. - **Wet stock** shows each tank's gain or loss as a share of what was sold from it. Past a quarter percent is **Watch**, past half a percent is **Investigate**. A tank not measured for over a day is flagged. - **Delivery.** Enter the litres on the delivery note, and measure the tank before and after the offload. The litres received are then what the tank really took, and any shortage against the note is recorded and flagged (over half a percent). Enter the supplier's **cost per litre** and the system keeps each tank's average cost, so **Reports** can show your margin. Fuel sold before a cost was known is left out of the margin and reported separately.

Prices. Every change of a pump price is kept with who made it, when, and from what to what (**History**). If you enter the regulator's monthly cap for a grade, a price above it is refused.

Fleet accounts. Companies that fuel on credit have a credit limit and a KRA PIN. Their sales are invoiced to them, a sale over the limit is refused, and payments are recorded from the account.

Receipts and the buyer's KRA PIN. When your business records fuel takings as sales (Settings, "Fuel, hotel, pharmacy and cyber takings"), recording a sale opens its receipt with the KRA status and a **Print** button, and prints it by itself if a receipt printer is set up. A customer who wants their KRA PIN on the receipt gives it in **Buyer's KRA PIN** on the sale screen (and, if they like, the name to print); it is checked for the right shape and goes to KRA with the receipt. A **fleet account** needs none: its own PIN is used. If real-sales is off, the screen says a PIN needs it rather than ignoring it. To print a receipt again later, open **Sales** and press **Receipt** on the sale (a sale KRA was not yet told about is sent then). A voided sale, or one from before real-sales was switched on, has no receipt.

Pump controller. Under **Setup** there is an optional connection to a pump controller. It has not been tested with a real controller, and you do not need it: the shift meter check catches any litre that is missed.

Older shifts. A shift that was already open when the nozzle meters were introduced cannot sell; close it (enter each pump's closing reading) and open a new one.

15. Stock, receiving and counting

Stock is never simply typed in. Every change is a recorded movement with a reason: a sale, a return, a delivery received, a transfer, a count adjustment, a write-off. That is why you can always answer *"where did those twelve go?"*.

Adding items — one at a time in **Inventory**, or in bulk by **CSV import**. Items can have **variants** (size, colour, weight) and be sold as **bundles** or made from a **recipe**.

Receiving stock — raise a purchase order, then receive against it (a GRN). What you actually received is recorded, so short deliveries show up in the **GRN Discrepancy** report rather than quietly vanishing.

Stocktake — open a stocktake session, count, and enter counts. KASTRA shows counted against expected, you review the variance, then commit. The adjustment is recorded with your name on it.

Transfers — move stock between stores. The sending store loses it and the receiving store gains it, with the movement recorded both ends.

Damaged goods — write off breakages and spoilage with a reason, so shrinkage is measured rather than guessed.

Barcode labels — generate and print labels for items and shelf edges.

16. Expiry dates and batches

If you sell food, medicine or anything else that goes off, turn on batch tracking for those items.

- Stock is received in **batches**, each with its own expiry date
- KASTRA sells **oldest-first (FEFO)** automatically — first expired, first out
- You get **expiry alerts** ahead of time so stock can be moved or discounted
- If someone tries to sell expired stock, the till **stops them** and names the batch
- A **recall** can pull a whole batch, and tell you which customers bought from it

- **Receiving creates the batch.** When a delivery is recorded as goods received, each batch-tracked item needs its **lot number** from the pack, and medicines also need the **expiry date**. A lot that has already expired is refused (send it back instead); a second delivery of the same lot tops it up; the same lot with a different expiry date is refused so a typing slip does not hide a short-dated pack.
- **The expiry dashboard** at the top of **Batch & Expiry** shows what is on the shelf already expired, expiring within 30, 31 to 60 and 61 to 90 days, and recalled lots to send back, each with the units and what they cost. Press a figure to see those lots. On each lot you can **return it to the supplier** (the units leave that lot and your stock, and a return note is made), **write it off** (recorded as a loss at cost), or recall it.

Serial numbers are the same idea for individually-tracked goods — electronics, appliances — where you need to know exactly which unit went to which customer.

17. Suppliers and purchase orders

- **Suppliers** — contacts, terms, and what you owe them
- **Purchase orders** — raise, send, and track them
- **Goods received (GRN)** — record what actually arrived, against an approved order. You cannot receive a line that is not on the order or more than is still outstanding (change the order first if the supplier sent extra); the form starts with what is still to come. The order is marked partly or fully received for you.
- **Returns to a supplier** — stock leaves the moment the return is made, from the lot you choose (an expired or recalled lot is exactly what is sent back) or oldest-first when you do not choose. KASTRA checks there is that much on hand and in the lot. Mark it **Credited** when the supplier credits you; **Cancel** a return that does not go ahead and the units go back into the lot and the store they left. Older returns made before this was recorded cannot be cancelled this way.
- **RFQ** — ask several suppliers to quote, compare, and pick. Suppliers respond through a link you send them; they do not need a login
- **Supplier ageing** — what you owe, by how overdue it is

Money

18. Cash drawer, shifts and closing the day

Opening. Declare your opening float when you start.

During the shift. Record cash paid in and out (a supplier paid in cash, a staff advance) so the drawer stays explainable.

X-report. A mid-shift snapshot. Read it any time; it changes nothing.

Z-report. The end-of-day close. It totals the day, closes it off, and is the number your books are built on.

Counting down. Enter what is physically in the drawer. KASTRA shows the difference against what it expected — over, under, or exact. Differences are recorded, which is the point.

19. Expenses and the books

- **Expenses** — record what the business spends, by category, with approval where you require it
- **Cheques** — track cheques in and out and when they clear
- **Ledger** — the underlying accounts
- **Reconciliation** — match your records against the bank and M-Pesa statements
- **Budgets** — set them and track against them

20. Reports worth knowing

There are 44 report tabs across six groups. These are the ones most businesses live on:

Report	Answers
X / Z Report	What happened today, and closing it off
Sales	What sold, when, by whom
Gross Margin	What you actually made, not just turnover
P & L	Profit and loss for the period
Dead Stock	What has not moved and is tying up cash
Shrinkage	What went missing
Credit Book	Who owes you
Supplier Ageing	Who you owe
Sales by Staff	Who is selling
Item Summary	Per-item performance
Basket Analysis	What gets bought together
Customer LTV	What a customer is worth over time

Report	Answers
VAT Return	Your VAT position
Audit Log	Who did what, tamper-evident

Every tab exports to **CSV**. VAT reports, receipts, purchase orders and B2B invoices also export to **PDF**. Reports can be **scheduled** to email themselves to you.

Forecasting predicts demand from your sales history so you order better.

21. KRA, VAT and eTIMS

KASTRA is built for Kenyan tax compliance.

- **VAT is inclusive.** The price on the shelf is what the customer pays; KASTRA extracts the VAT within it. It does not add VAT on top at the till.
- **TOT** (turnover tax) is supported for businesses not on VAT.
- **eTIMS** — sales are submitted to KRA automatically after checkout. Voids and amendments go too.
- **Offline** — if KRA is unreachable, submissions queue and go when the connection returns. You keep trading.
- **KRA export** — produce the files KRA asks for.
- **Audit log** — tamper-evident, and exportable.

Your KRA credentials are entered once in **Settings -> eTIMS** and stored encrypted. Start in **test** mode; switch to **production** once KRA approves you.

Beyond the counter

22. Selling online and to customers' phones

Each of these is a link you can print, share or turn into a QR code. **None of them require the customer to install anything.**

What	Link	For
Web storefront	`/shop/<your business>`	Browsing and ordering online
QR menu	`/menu/<your business>`	Table menus in a restaurant
Older ordering link	`/order/<your business>`	Sends the customer to the web storefront, so links you already printed keep working
Payment link	`/pay/<code>`	Send someone a link to pay you
Order tracking	`/track/<order number>`	Customer follows their delivery
Customer portal	`/portal`	Customers sign in with a phone code to see orders, points and account

Orders placed through these arrive in **Online Orders** for you to accept and fulfil.

23. Delivery

- Take delivery orders from the shop, the storefront or the phone apps
- Assign a **driver**
- The customer gets a **tracking link** showing the driver's live position
- Drivers confirm delivery on their phone, with proof
- **Delivery routes** plan a driver's whole run rather than one drop at a time

24. Field sales and B2B invoicing

For businesses that sell out of a van or through agents on the road.

The agent, on their phone: - Sees a **call plan** — which shops to visit, prioritised by who owes the most - Registers new shops, with GPS - Takes orders against a shop's credit limit - Collects payments and records them - Works with no signal — everything queues and syncs later

The office, on the web: - Orders arrive on the **Field Orders** board - **Generate Invoice** for the full order, or **Partial Invoice** for only what was actually delivered - **Invoice All Delivered** does the whole day's delivered orders at once - **Record Payment** — cash, M-Pesa, bank or

cheque - The customer is notified by WhatsApp or SMS automatically - **B2B Invoice PDF** with your letterhead, itemised lines, payment terms and bank details - **Invoice Ageing** buckets what is outstanding: 0–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+ days

You can also save a POS cart as a **proforma invoice** rather than a sale — useful when a business customer needs a quote before they will pay.

25. Staff, leave and payroll

- **Staff records**, roles and pay rates
- **Commission** — by sales value, transaction count, or gross margin
- **Leave** with running balances
- **Shift scheduling**, plus sales per shift
- **Attendance**
- **Disciplinary records** and **salary advances**
- **Payroll** — Kenyan PAYE, **SHIF**, NSSF and the Affordable Housing Levy
- **Payslips** generated per employee

  Payroll follows the **SHIF** rules that replaced NHIF. Older payslips keep the figures they were generated with.

26. The mobile apps

Four separate Android apps, each for one job.

App	Who	What it does
KASTRA POS	Cashiers, managers	A full till in your hand, plus a Manage section for stock, counts, transfers, approvals and day-close
KASTRA Order	Your customers	Browse the menu, order, pay by M-Pesa, book a table, check points
KASTRA Driver	Drivers	Assigned drops, navigation hand-off, delivery confirmation, earnings
KASTRA Agent	Field sales agents	Call plan, orders, collections, new shop registration

All four work offline and sync when signal returns.

Pointing an app at your server: on the login screen, set the server address. Your installer will give you this. It defaults to the cloud service.

Receipt printing on mobile is off by default, because most mobile selling has no printer and sends the receipt by SMS or WhatsApp instead. Turn it on in the app's Settings, then choose how the phone reaches the printer:

- **Bluetooth** for small receipt printers. Pair the printer in the phone's Bluetooth settings first, then choose it in the app. Android only.
- **Wi-Fi / LAN** for counter printers: type the printer's address, for example `192.168.1.50`. The phone must be on the same Wi-Fi.

- **Print dialog** to use the phone's own print system or save a PDF.

Also choose the **paper size**: 58 mm for the small Bluetooth printers, 80 mm for standard thermal printers. The receipt is laid out to fit the paper you choose. With Bluetooth or Wi-Fi you can switch on **Print automatically** so each sale prints the moment it completes. Use **Print test receipt** to check the setup.

Running the shop

27. Settings you will actually use

Setting	Why you would touch it
Business type	Changes the whole till — restaurant, retail, fuel, pharmacy…
Receipt	Logo, header, footer wording
Tax	VAT or TOT, and your rate
eTIMS	KRA credentials, test or production
Payments	M-Pesa, Paystack, bank details
Users	Add staff, set roles and PINs
Stores	Multiple branches
Printers	The receipt printer for this device, and which printer gets food and which gets drinks
Loyalty	Earn and redeem rates
Security	Two-factor, password rules, lockouts

28. Your plan and what it unlocks

Plan	KES/month	Stores	Users
Free	0	1	1
Starter	999	1	8
Growth	2,499	2	15
Pro	4,999	5	30
Enterprise	14,999	Unlimited	Unlimited

Roughly what each adds:

- **Free** — the till, stock, customers, sales list, cash drawer
- **Starter** — reports, batch tracking, receipt customisation
- **Growth** — restaurant and bar, kitchen screen, pharmacy, delivery, suppliers, promotions, gift cards, stocktake
- **Pro** — multi-store transfers, owner dashboard, HR and payroll, ledger, reconciliation, API keys, scheduled reports
- **Enterprise** — field sales, delivery routes, hotel, channel manager, forecasting, franchise

During your trial you get everything, so you can see what you actually need. When the trial ends, your plan's features apply.

If a menu item is missing, it is on a higher plan. Clicking it explains which.

Referring other businesses

If you recommend KASTRA to another business and they sign up, you earn a reward through the **referral programme**. Your referral link is in Settings.

There is also a separate **affiliate programme** for people who promote KASTRA commercially and earn ongoing commission — you do not need to be a KASTRA customer to join it. Affiliates get their own sign-in at `/affiliate`, which is separate from your POS login and gives no access to any business's data.

29. Working offline

KASTRA is built to keep selling when the internet does not.

What still works offline: taking sales, printing receipts, looking up cached items and customers.

What happens to those sales: they are saved on the device and sent up when the connection returns. Each one carries a unique ID, so a sale that was actually received before the connection dropped is **never charged twice** on retry.

What you will see: a sync indicator showing how many are waiting.

What does not work offline: anything that needs a live third party — M-Pesa STK, card payments, and live KRA submission. eTIMS submissions queue and go later.

> **On the mobile cashier app**, the offline queue is flushed from the **Sync** button in Settings. If you have been selling offline, open Settings and tap Sync once you are back on signal.

30. When something goes wrong

"No sales found" but there are sales Your session expired. Sign in again.

A menu item disappeared Either your role does not include it, or it is on a higher plan.

M-Pesa says "waiting for payment" forever The customer never approved it on their phone. Cancel and retry, or take another payment method. Never hand over goods on an unconfirmed STK.

"Credit limit exceeded" The sale would put the customer past their limit. A manager can raise it on the customer's record, or take part payment now.

The receipt printer does nothing Check power and cable first. Then open **Settings, Printers** and press **Print test receipt**; the message beside the button says what is wrong. A USB or Bluetooth printer must be paired on this device (press **Pair**), and a browser can forget a Bluetooth pairing after a restart. For kitchen tickets, check the category is routed to that printer. If the printer cannot be reached during a sale, the print choices open so the receipt is not lost.

Stock looks wrong Open the item's movement history. Every change is listed with a reason and a name.

Expired-stock warning I need to get past That is deliberate. Check the batch. If it genuinely is fine, a manager can resolve it — but the warning is there because selling expired goods is a real liability.

Sales are not reaching KRA Check the eTIMS status in Settings. If the queue is backing up, your credentials or connection need attention — tell whoever runs your server.

The app is slow or behaving oddly Refresh the page. If it persists on one device only, that device is the problem, not the system.

31. Quick reference card

Keyboard

Key	Action
`/`	Search
`F1`	Cash sale
`F5`	Hold sale
`F6`	Recall held sale

Quick entry

Type	Result
`3x500`	Three of the item priced KES 500
Scan a scale label	Weighed item, tare deducted

The three ways to undo

Situation	Do this	Needs
Not paid yet	Edit the cart	Nothing
Paid, cancel it	**Void**	Manager PIN + reason
Paid, goods coming back	**Return**	Per your settings

Daily rhythm

1. Sign in, declare your float
2. Sell
3. X-report to check mid-shift
4. Count the drawer
5. **Z-report** to close the day

32. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Batch / lot	A delivery of stock with its own expiry date
eTIMS	KRA's electronic tax invoice system
FEFO	First Expired, First Out — oldest stock sells first
Folio	A hotel guest's running bill
GRN	Goods Received Note — what actually arrived
KOT	Kitchen Order Ticket
KDS	Kitchen Display Screen

Term	Meaning
Layaway	Customer pays in instalments; goods held until paid
PAYE	Kenyan income tax deducted from salaries
Proforma	A quote — looks like an invoice, is not a sale
RFQ	Request for Quotation — ask suppliers to bid
SHIF	Social Health Insurance Fund, replaced NHIF
STK push	The M-Pesa prompt that appears on a customer's phone
Shrinkage	Stock lost to theft, damage or error
Tare	The container's own weight, deducted from weighed goods
TOT	Turnover Tax, for businesses not registered for VAT
VSCU	The offline eTIMS queue that holds sales until KRA is reachable
X / Z report	Mid-shift snapshot / end-of-day close

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*Need the installation and server side instead? See the **Admin & Installation Guide**.*